FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-32-17031

Issue Title : MLG OUTER CYLINDER GLAND NUT THREAD CORROSION

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	3210-00	-7, -8, -8200, -9, -BBJ

Other Model(s)	ECCN
737NG	9E991

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
12/04/2017	12/04/2017	04/19/2017

Estimated Completion Date	Next Update Date

Applicability

Applicable to MLG outer cylinder gland nut threads and NLG outer cylinder gland nut threads of all 737MAX aircraft.

Description

Several 737NG operators have experienced MLG Outer Cylinder gland nut thread corrosion at first overhaul requiring oversizing of the gland nut threads.

Background

Many 737 and 737NG MLG outer cylinders have been oversized at the gland nut threads at first overhaul due to corrosion.

Status

Corrosion of the outer cylinder gland nut threads can be due to a combination of the following:

1. Lack of Corrosion Inhibiting Compounds at the gland nut / MLG outer cylinder joint. Current Boeing design philosophy is to use CICs at gland nut threads. Since gland nuts are not installed or serviced with grease, extra care must be taken to preserve the required CICs applied during gland nut installation. Any removal of the gland nut (such as for seal changes) requires reapplication of the gland nut CICs.

2. Excessive Landing Gear Washing. Gear washing should be avoided as much as possible. High pressure washing should be especially avoided because it can displace CICs and lubricants, and trap moisture.

3. Use of Cleaners during washing. When landing gear washing is accomplished with a cleaner, Boeing recommends using the most mild cleaners from the list of approved material D6-17487. Boeing recommend operators use the most dilute mixture possible to do the job.

Interim Action

None.

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Final Action

Boeing has developed 1/8 and 1/4 inch oversized gland nut thread repairs for the MLG outer cylinders and these repairs are included in CMM 32-11-12, Repair 3-2. Oversize gland nuts P/N 161A1154-2 (1/8th inch oversize) and P/N 161A1154-3 (1/4 inch oversize) have been designed and can be ordered from Boeing Spares.

For the NLG, 1/16th and 1/8th inch oversize repairs are included in CMM 32-21-12, Repair 2-2. Oversize gland nuts P/N 162A1513-2 (1/16th inch oversize) and P/N 162A1513-3 (1/8th inch oversize) have been designed and can be ordered from Boeing Spares.

Operator Action

Monitor fleet during applicable maintenance activities and first overhauls to ensure CICs are present and gland nut threads are not corroded.

If an operator is experiencing significant gland nut corrosion or CICs are not discovered during gland nut removals, then adjust maintenance practices to ensure that CICs are maintained.

1. Reduce or eliminate washing.

2. Replace CICs during shock strut disassembly.

3. Incorporate CIC replacement into scheduled maintenance to control the corrosion at this joint.

4. Adjust to a milder or more diluted cleaner.

MLG and NLG Outer Cylinders can be repaired at overhaul by oversizing the gland nut threads on the outer cylinder and installing an applicable oversized gland nut.

Part Information

MLG outer cylinder, P/N 161A1118-3xx.

NLG outer cylinder, P/N 162A1110-3xx.

Reference Categories

Reference Type	Reference Number	Revision Number	Reference Date
Component Maintenance Manual (CMM)	32-11-12		
Fleet Team Economic (FTE)	03365-737NG		
Component Maintenance Manual (CMM)	32-21-12		

Parts List

Part Name	Boeing Part Number	Supplier Name	Supplier Number
NLG Outer Cylinder	162A1110-3xx		

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MLG Outer Cylinder	161A1118-3xx		

Related Categories

- Airplane Maintenance Issues : Issues that occur during airplane maintenance or have an impact on airplane reliability
- Component Issues : Issues that occur during component maintenance or have an impact on component reliability

Attachments:

a) MLG GLAND NUT THREAD CORROSION

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